Holiday Survival Planner

Event plans, limits, scripts and recovery pages for a calmer holiday season.

How to use this planner

Fill one event page per gathering. Decide your limits before you arrive; it's much easier than deciding in the moment. Keep your exit line short and kind.

Plan in three parts: before (limits, logistics), during (scripts, breaks), after (recovery, reflection).

Personal-use license. Please don't share the file.

Season overview

Date	Event / host	Arrive	Leave by	Budget

Event plan 1

Event, date, who will be there:

My non-negotiables (sleep, food, time, topics):

Topics I'll steer away from, and my redirect line:

How I'm getting there and home (my own exit?):

My leave-by time and kind exit line:

Who's my ally there? Our signal:

One thing I'm looking forward to:

Event plan 2

Event, date, who will be there:

My non-negotiables (sleep, food, time, topics):

Topics I'll steer away from, and my redirect line:

How I'm getting there and home (my own exit?):

My leave-by time and kind exit line:

Who's my ally there? Our signal:

One thing I'm looking forward to:

Event plan 3

Event, date, who will be there:

My non-negotiables (sleep, food, time, topics):

Topics I'll steer away from, and my redirect line:

How I'm getting there and home (my own exit?):

My leave-by time and kind exit line:

Who's my ally there? Our signal:

One thing I'm looking forward to:

Gift and money limits

Person	Limit	Idea	Bought ☐

Money sentence I can use: (e.g., "We're keeping gifts simple this year.")

Scripts for common moments

Comment about weight, food or your choices: "I'd rather not talk about that today. How's your garden doing?"

Pushing you to stay longer: "I've loved this. We're heading out at eight like we planned."

Hosting pressure: "We can't host this year. We'd love to bring dessert."

Unwanted advice: "Thanks, I'll think about it." (Then change the subject.)

Politics: "I'm taking a holiday from politics. Tell me about your trip."

Guilt trip: "I hear that you're disappointed. My answer is still no."

Partner check-in: "Want to step outside for five minutes?"

My own script:

Recovery and reflection

What I'll do the day after to recharge:

What went better than expected:

Where a limit slipped, and why:

What I'll do differently next year:

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